

Hacking Ported

Developers have figured how to extract files from the Universal Media Discs used in Sony's PlayStation Portable, though there is no way to play the extracted games. Movie studios will release some of their films on the UMD format, but it's not clear if the technique would work for films.



New Windows For Fake

Microsoft is offering Americans compensation if they bought a dodgy copy of Windows in exchange for information on its source. The compensation will be in the form of a handy little product activation key by e-mail, followed by a nice new legit copy of Windows XP in the post.



Enter

Bharat Dabholkar

Film Actor And Director

A lawyer, advertising professional, actor, fitness enthusiast and now a film director—Bharat Dabholkar's roles in real life are as interesting and varied as those in reel life. Here's his take on technology.

What does technology mean to you?

I think technology is essential to make life easier. The new tools are giving a new perspective to life.

What role does technology play in your life?

I read about all the latest developments in the market.

How often do you surf the Net?

Everyday—I check my mails regularly, and get my daily dose of technology updates by reading online.

What gadgets do you own?

I do not own anything beyond my cell phone and Tablet PC.

What do you feel about convergence of devices?

Convergence is very futuristic, but is beneficial to the consumer. However, people usually end up buying things impulsively, and later realise that they do not use these hi-tech products.

You have been a lawyer, actor, and advertising professional. Where has technology evolved the most?

The entertainment industry has been the largest beneficiary. Today, it is possible to make and transfer films digitally, saving huge amounts of money. Besides, it also reaches a wider audience. Technology can also help improve the quality of films and help curb piracy.

IS THE TIGER LIMPING?

Security Holes And Compatibility Issues Could Plague Tiger

The Tiger is on the prowl and everyone raving about its new features and considering the initial sales figures it may surpass the Panther's first quarter sales figure very soon.

But is everything sunny in Tiger land? Bugs and errors are being reported daily, and the present trickle could turn into a torrent if Apple and their associates don't take remedial measures.

Programmers have detected a security hole in Dashboard, a suite of programs called widgets that often access information on the Internet, which could expose users of Tiger to attack, and may put personal information like passwords and credit card data at risk.

Tiger comes preloaded with 14 widgets, including a world clock, a dictionary and a weather station. For the convenience of users, most widgets automatically install themselves. Experts fear that any program that auto-installs is ripe for exploitation.

A growing number of Mac experts are sounding the alarm over the dangers of widgets—which can carry Unix commands that could be run invisibly from within.

A few of the other widely reported flaws are SMB file sharing and authentication problems with Microsoft's Active Directory. Although Apple's Tiger increases support for Server Message Block file sharing and Active Directory, several sources say that the Finder fails to log on to Windows and Linux Samba file servers.

Some installations are also finding that Windows workstations can't log on to the Mac after upgrading to Mac OS X 10.4.

Another niggling problem is a compatibility issue with enterprise software. Adobe said Acrobat 7 has a problem with QuickTime 7, which ships with Tiger.

"We are aware of an issue that prevents the playback of QuickTime content embedded in PDF files when using QuickTime 7 Player on all supported versions of Mac OS X," said an Adobe representative. Adobe said that it would issue a fix in an upcoming maintenance release, but did not say when.

Five of Symantec's Mac products are incompatible with Tiger, but the company said there was nothing unusual about the Tiger release due to the nature of Symantec's utility software.

Tiger also has caused some incompatibility with driver-level software related to hardware. The Radeon X800 XT graphics card from ATI Technologies has ROM software that is incompatible with Tiger.

The ROM software can cause a kernel panic, a type of crash when the Mac screen is covered with lines of code.

Users can also see kernel panics when upgrading to Tiger with Maxtor FireWire and USB hard drives connected to the Mac. Maxtor, in fact, recommends that users disconnect Maxtor external drives before running Apple's Tiger installer.

The company, though, said it could not predict when a fix for these holes could be available.

Illustrations: Harsho Mohan Chatteraj

